

LATEST TVs

For You

To woo consumers, TV manufacturers are becoming more and more innovative. So you can find LCD TVs with gaming or DTH built into them and also a whole lot of LED and the latest 3-D TVs besides improvements in the conventional LCD and plasma TVs



■ **UMA BANSAL**

Thin LCD and plasma TVs have already replaced bulky CRT TVs in many homes. Now you find in the market even thinner LED TVs and also 3-D TVs that offer life-like experience. If you have still not switched to a flat-panel TV or are thinking to upgrade to the latest LED TV or 3-D TV, you better understand beforehand how these TVs differ in terms of technology, design, features and price.

So here you go.

LCD Vs LED Vs plasma

Technology and design. "An LCD TV has liquid crystals between the

display panels of the TV, which get activated when an electric current is supplied. An LED TV works on the same liquid-crystal platform, but light-emitting diodes (LEDs) are used as the backlight for this TV, while the normal LCD TV uses a CCFL backlight," explains Prasun Banerjee, director-sales & marketing, consumer electronics divisions, Haier Appliances India. Use of LEDs as the light source makes LED TVs slimmer than LCD TVs.

Plasma TVs work on a completely different platform. The gas discharge releases electrons, which hit the red-green-blue (RGB) colour dots to create different colours.

Thus plasma and LCD technologies are completely different, while the dif-

ference between the LCD and LED TVs is only the backlight.

"There are two types of LED TVs: Edge LED TVs, which have LEDs placed at edges, and full LED TVs, which have LEDs placed at the back of the entire screen. Most of the leading brands are using Edge LED technology. Barring this difference, the technology of LED and LCD TVs is the same," informs Anirudh V. Dhoot, head-sales & marketing, Videocon.

Features. LED TVs have a higher brightness and are thinner than LCD and plasma TVs. However, most of the advanced features like 3-D, Bluetooth, Wi-Fi, DLNA and high motion rate are available across all product categories.

Coming to LCD vs plasma TVs, plasma TVs refresh at the rate of 600 frames/second, while LCD TVs have a refresh rate of only 50 frames/second (you pay Rs 10,000 extra to get 100 Hz only). Viewing angle is much wider (178°) than of LCD TV's (45°). Also the viewing distance is much less—just 1.7 metres (5.5 feet) for a 107cm (42-inch) plasma TV as against 4.6 metres (15 feet) for the same size of an LCD TV. Contrast ratio is much higher at 2,000,000:1 than LCD TV's 150,000:1. Life is 100,000 hours (33 years) compared to LCD TV's 60,000 hours (15 years).

However, plasma TVs heat up, have dull colours (compared to LCD TVs) and consume more power than LCD TVs.

Realising the potential for sales,